

STRATEGIC MARKET-ENTRY ASSESSMENT

The Mycoprotein Opportunity

Sizing the prize in fungal biomass fermentation — and how to enter it, benchmarked against plant-based meat and plant protein

Prepared for a strategic investor evaluating entry into commercial mycoprotein production. Covers market size and growth, competitive structure, unit economics, capital flows, regulation across the US, Europe and Brazil, demand scenarios, risks and a recommended playbook.

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Independent analysis · July 2026

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How to read this document

This is a decision document, not an encyclopedia. Each section opens with the answer, then shows the evidence. The recommendation lives in Section 12; the one-page thesis is on the next page. Figures are triangulated from multiple third-party estimates and company disclosures and should be read as directional ranges, not audited accounts — the alternative-protein data landscape is noisy, and false precision would be misleading.

SECTION 00

Executive summary

Mycoprotein is the most investable corner of the alternative-protein landscape right now — but only for an entrant who treats it as an **industrial B2B ingredient business** anchored by cheap feedstock and secured offtake, not as another branded meat substitute. The consumer “fake-meat” retail thesis has broken; the fermentation-ingredient thesis has not. The two are routinely conflated, and that confusion is precisely where the opportunity for a disciplined entrant sits.

Bottom line up front

Enter mycoprotein as a **commodity-scale, B2B biomass-fermentation ingredient** play. Lead with meat-analogue and blended applications (poultry-style first), co-locate a first commercial plant of roughly **15–20k tonnes/year** with a carbohydrate feedstock source, and secure an offtake partner before pouring concrete. Treat branded retail as an optional downstream, not the core bet. The prize is real but the category is unforgiving of asset-heavy, brand-led capital.

~\$0.7–0.8B

Mycoprotein market, 2025 (a sliver of the ~\$20B plant-protein pool)

\$4–6/kg

Biomass cost of production — below beef & pork wholesale

~75%

Share of Q1 2026 alt-protein funding going to fermentation

–19%

US retail alt-meat \$ sales since the 2023 peak

Six findings that frame the decision

- **A small niche with a structural edge.** At ~\$0.7–0.8B, mycoprotein is barely 1.4% of the ~\$20B plant-protein-ingredient pool and a rounding error against the ~\$53B total protein-ingredient market. But it grows ~8–10%+, and — uniquely — it beats *both* meat and plant proteins on greenhouse gas, land and water while delivering protein, fibre and a complete amino-acid profile in a whole-food format.
- **Don’t confuse the plant-based slump with the death of alt-protein.** US retail meat-analogue sales are down ~19% since 2023 and ~10% in 2025, yet global plant-based meat still grew ~8% and capital is rotating hard into fermentation. The failure was a branded-CPG, retail-shelf failure — not a failure of the protein source.
- **Business model is the whole game.** The survivors are B2B ingredient suppliers with feedstock integration and offtake (ENOUGH, backed by Cargill). The casualties are asset-heavy branded players: Meati raised ~\$450M and sold for ~\$4M; Quorn, the 40-year category creator, books heavy losses and repeated impairments on ~£187M of revenue.
- **Biomass fermentation has genuinely attractive economics.** Cost of production is ~\$4–6/kg — below beef and pork (\$6–15/kg) and far below precision fermentation (\$18+/kg) — because it harvests whole biomass with minimal downstream purification. The binding constraint is capital intensity and the scale-up “valley of death.” Feedstock cost and yield are the single biggest levers on returns.
- **Regulation is both moat and map.** Approvals are a patchwork: the US (GRAS) is fastest and cheapest, Singapore is a quick strategic beachhead, Brazil now has a defined pathway (ANVISA RDC 839/2023), and the EU is slow and costly (2–6 years) but confers durable credibility. Timelines are an entry barrier that rewards the well-advised.
- **Where to play / how to win.** Capture the B2B “commodity-scale ingredient” white space that ENOUGH is pioneering and Quorn is only now reaching for. Enter via partner/offtake, co-locate with feedstock, size the first plant at ~15–20k t/yr, and win on cost-down, application performance and supply reliability rather than brand.

SECTION 01

Context, scope and how we sized it

This assessment answers one question: **should a strategic investor enter commercial mycoprotein production, and if so, how?** It is written for an investor comparing this opportunity against the broader plant-based and plant-protein markets, and it is deliberately even-handed about the category's headwinds.

Scope

- **Product.** Fungal biomass grown by fermentation for human food — primarily *mycoprotein* in the strict sense (filamentous fungi such as *Fusarium venenatum*), plus adjacent fungal-biomass ingredients. We touch precision and gas fermentation only for contrast.
- **Applications.** Two demand vectors: (i) mycoprotein as a *protein-supplement ingredient* competing with whey, soy and pea isolates; and (ii) wet mycoprotein *biomass as the core of meat-analogue products*, competing with plant-based meat.
- **Geographies.** Brazil, the United States and Europe — the three markets with the most relevant demand potential and the clearest (if uneven) regulatory routes.
- **Decision.** Whether to build, partner or buy; where to play; how to win; and how big a first plant should be.

Method at a glance

We triangulated published market estimates, company filings and disclosures, non-profit industry data (Good Food Institute), retail scanner and consumption data (SPINS, Euromonitor), peer-reviewed life-cycle assessments and techno-economic models, and regulatory registers. Where third-party numbers diverge — and for market size they diverge by up to 5× — we present a range and a reasoned base case rather than a single spurious figure. All monetary figures are USD unless noted.

A note on data quality

Alternative-protein market research is unusually noisy: definitions differ (does “mycoprotein” mean the ingredient, the finished product, or the whole meat-substitute shelf?), and vendors have incentives to publish large numbers. We flag the boundary for every figure and lean on *primary* disclosures — capacity, funding, filings — wherever possible.

SECTION 02

What mycoprotein is — and where it sits

Mycoprotein is protein-rich fungal biomass grown by fermentation and harvested whole. The category creator, Quorn, has grown *Fusarium venenatum* in steel tanks since the 1980s; a wave of newer entrants now grows other fungi by the same basic route. Understanding the fermentation taxonomy is essential, because the four approaches have **radically different economics** — and most of the investment noise (and most of the failures) sits outside biomass fermentation.

EXHIBIT 1

Four fermentation routes — mycoprotein is a biomass play

The economics differ by an order of magnitude across these rows.

Route	What it does	Representative players	Mycoprotein?
Traditional fermentation	Microbes transform a substrate (age/culture food)	Tempeh, koji, cultured dairy	Adjacent — not the focus
Biomass fermentation	Grow whole microbial cells fast; harvest the biomass itself	Quorn, ENOUGH/ABUNDA, Nature's Fynd, Meati, Fermotein, Rhiza	YES — mycoprotein lives here
Precision fermentation	Engineer microbes to secrete a specific molecule	Perfect Day (whey), Remilk (casein), Impossible (heme)	No — costlier, purification-heavy
Gas fermentation	Feed microbes CO ₂ / H ₂ / methane instead of sugar	Solar Foods (Solein), Calysta, Unibio	No — earlier-stage

Source: Independent analysis; company disclosures.

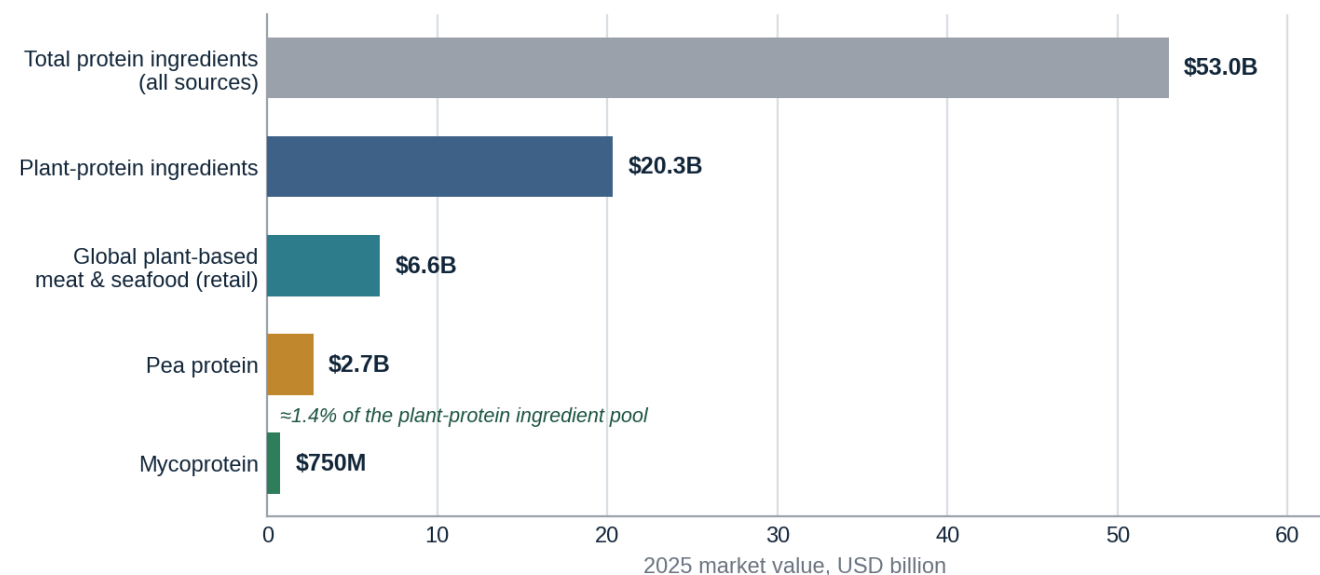
Why biomass fermentation is the sweet spot

Because biomass fermentation grows and harvests the *entire* cell rather than isolating and purifying a single molecule, its downstream processing is far lighter than precision fermentation's. That is the root of its cost advantage — and the reason mycoprotein can credibly chase parity with animal protein while precision fermentation still struggles against commodity ingredients. It also yields a whole-food ingredient (protein + fibre) rather than an isolate, which shapes both its nutritional positioning and its consumer story.

EXHIBIT 2

Mycoprotein is a sliver of the protein economy today

Where the category sits within the nested protein-market stack (2025).



Source: Independent analysis triangulating published market estimates; GFI; Euromonitor. Boundaries differ by source; figures are directional.

The strategic read

Being small is the opportunity, not the problem. Mycoprotein is early enough that a single well-run 20k-tonne plant is a *material* share of global supply — unlike pea protein, where a new entrant is a price-taker against entrenched majors. The question is not “is the market big?” but “can we build a low-cost, reliable supply position before the category scales?”

SECTION 03

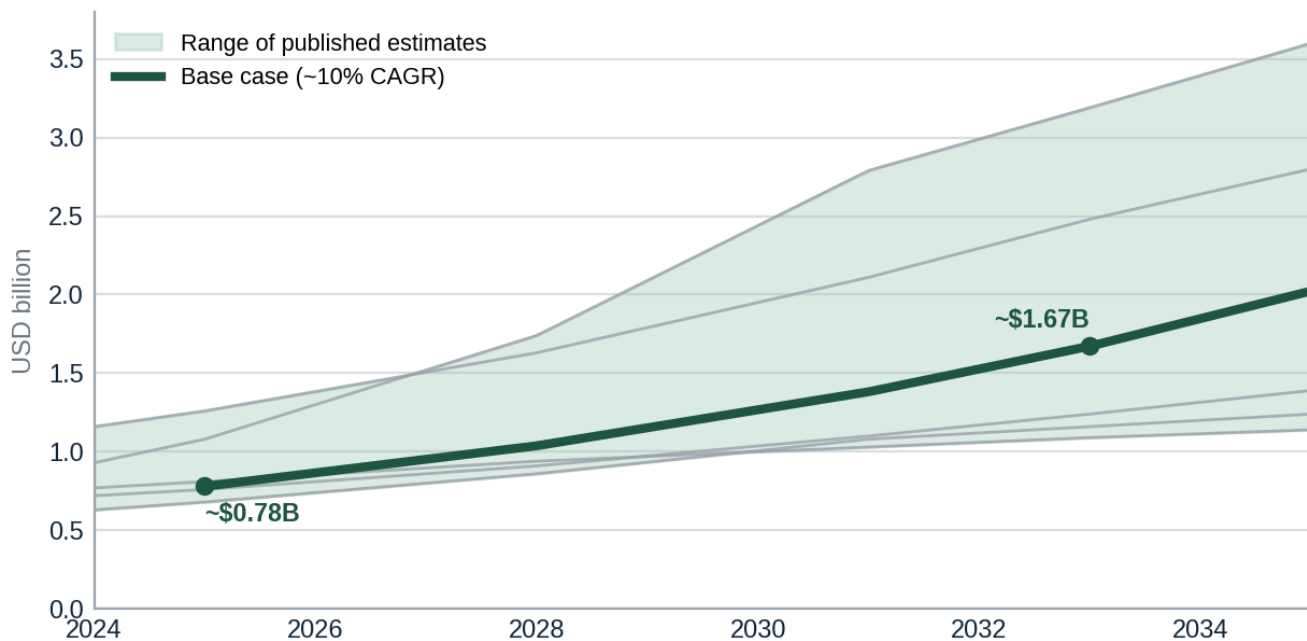
Market size and growth

Mycoprotein is a **~\$0.7–0.8B market in 2025**, most credibly forecast to roughly double to the **\$1.5–2.5B range by the early-to-mid 2030s** — a ~8–10% base-case CAGR, though published estimates run anywhere from 5% to 17%. That spread is itself a finding: the category's trajectory is genuinely uncertain and hinges on whether it escapes the branded-retail model that is dragging on the wider meat-analogue shelf.

EXHIBIT 3

A wide forecast cone around a doubling base case

Global mycoprotein market value; shaded band spans published third-party estimates.



Source: Independent analysis; range reflects five published estimate sets. Base case ~\$0.78B (2025) compounding at ~10%.

Put in context against the comparison markets

- **vs plant-protein ingredients (~\$20B, ~8.5% CAGR).** Mycoprotein is tiny beside the pea/soy/wheat isolate pool but growing at a similar-or-faster clip and from a far smaller base — the classic profile of an emerging ingredient.
- **vs pea protein (~\$2.7B).** Even the current darling of plant protein is only ~3.5× mycoprotein's size; mycoprotein's differentiation (fibre, complete EAAs, sustainability) is arguably sharper than pea's.
- **vs global plant-based meat & seafood (~\$6.6B retail).** This is mycoprotein's most direct *end-market*. It grew ~8% globally in 2025 even as the US retail slice fell — a reminder that the addressable demand is real but geographically uneven.
- **vs total protein ingredients (~\$53B).** The ceiling is enormous if mycoprotein ever competes as a mainstream protein input rather than a niche meat-analogue base.

SECTION 04

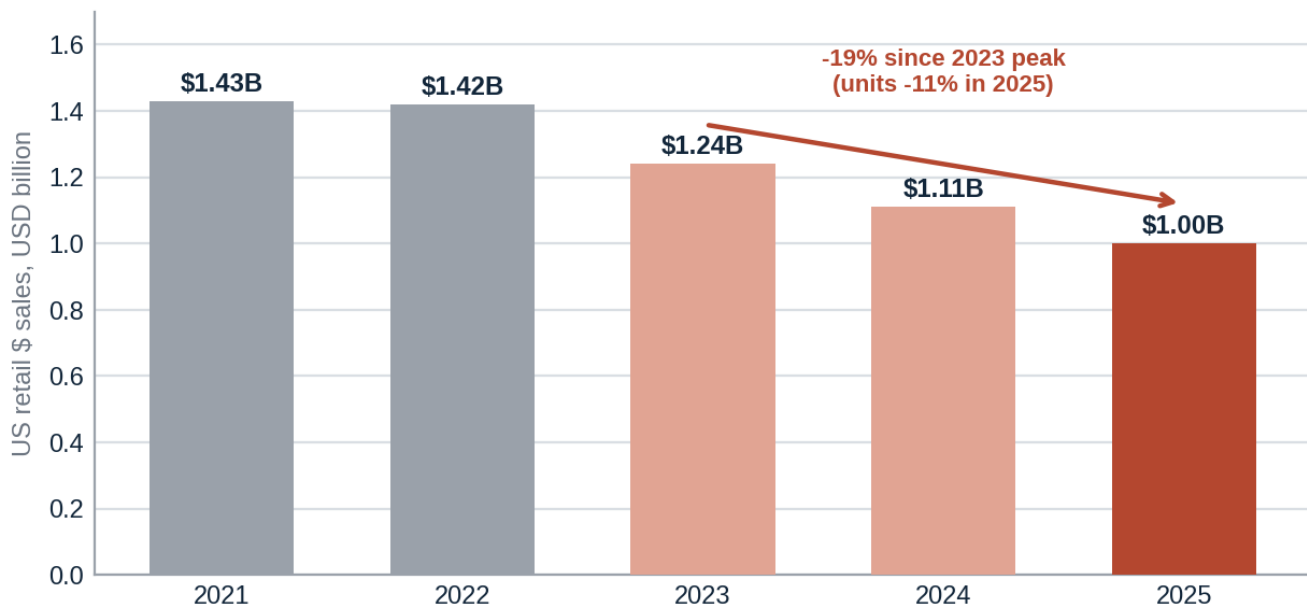
The plant-based reality check

Any entry thesis has to confront the elephant in the room: the branded plant-based meat category has been in a multi-year slump in its most developed markets. This is the single most important piece of context for an investor — and the most misread. **The slump is a business-model and product problem, not proof that consumers have abandoned protein diversification.**

EXHIBIT 4

US retail alt-meat has fallen for three straight years

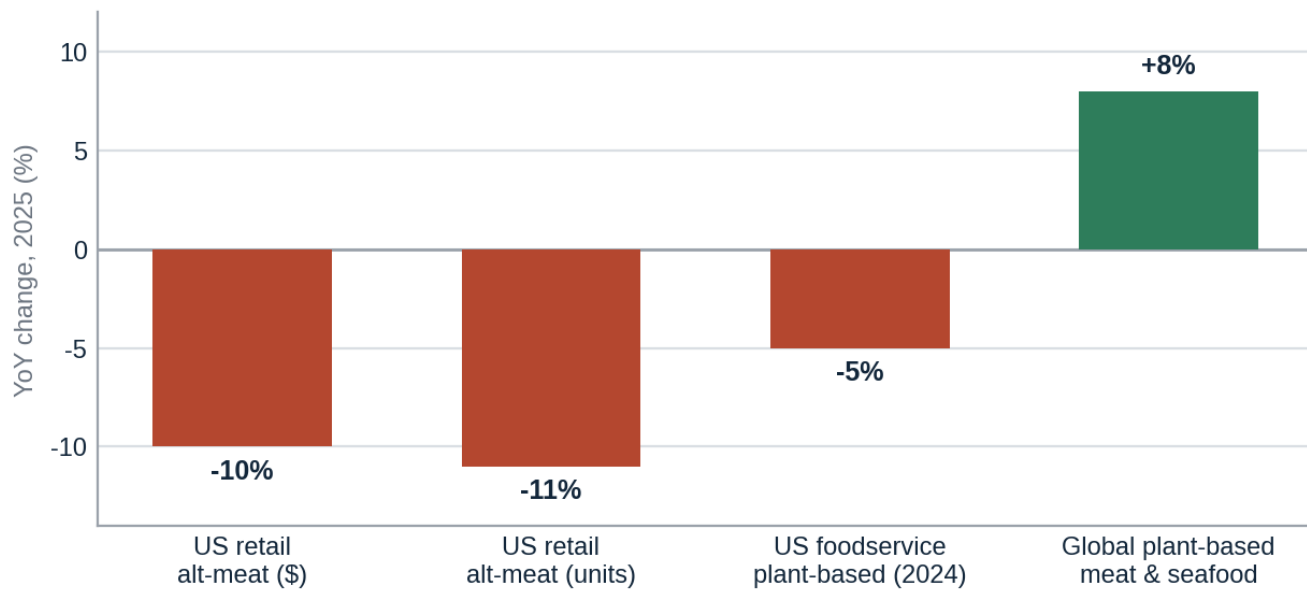
US retail dollar sales of plant-based meat & seafood (illustrative, triangulated).



Source: Independent analysis anchored to GFI/SPINS data points (2025 sales ~\$1.0B, -10% YoY, units -11%; -19% since 2023). Annual path is illustrative.

The proximate causes are well understood: premium pricing into an inflation-squeezed consumer, taste-and-texture that under-delivered against the “better burger” promise, a growing “ultra-processed” perception, and over-distribution that outran genuine repeat demand. Category bellwether Beyond Meat has carried heavy losses and a large debt load; Quorn’s owner has taken repeated impairments.

EXHIBIT 5

The category is repositioning, not uniformly dying*Divergent 2025 growth signals across channels and geographies.**Source: Independent analysis; GFI; SPINS; Euromonitor. US foodservice figure is 2024.***Why this helps a disciplined mycoprotein entrant**

First, it has reset valuations and cleared weak competitors — assets and talent are available cheaply. Second, it validates the pivot the smart money is already making: away from own-brand retail and toward **B2B ingredient supply, foodservice and blended (meat + mycoprotein) products**, where mycoprotein's texture and nutrition actually win. An entrant who never builds a consumer brand sidesteps the exact trap that snared the category's pioneers.

SECTION 05

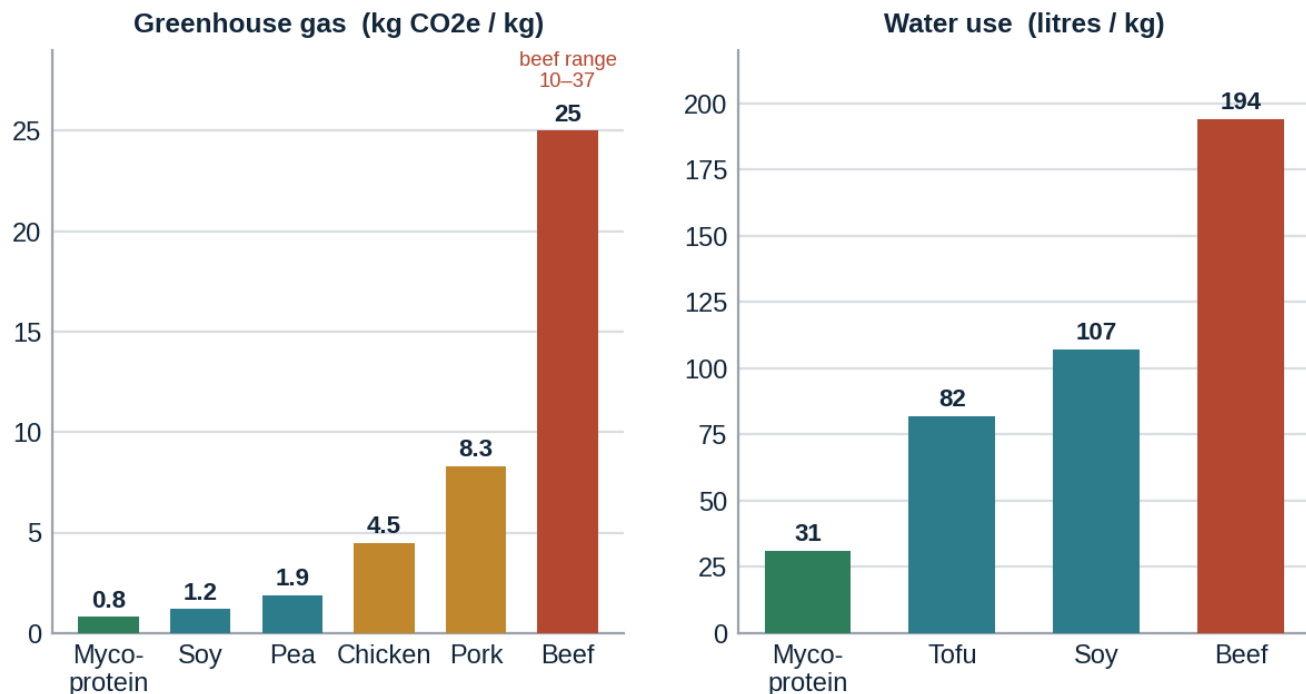
Why mycoprotein is structurally different

Mycoprotein is not just “another plant-based option.” On the two axes investors should care about most — **sustainability** and **nutrition** — it holds a defensible, evidence-backed edge over both animal *and* plant proteins. That edge is the durable reason to believe the category outlives the current downturn.

EXHIBIT 6

Lower footprint than meat — and than plant proteins

Cradle-to-gate life-cycle impacts per kg of protein/product.



Source: Peer-reviewed LCAs and systematic reviews (incl. Carbon Trust/Quorn footprint reports; Shahid et al. 2024; Derbyshire 2020). Beef GHG spans 10–37.

The sustainability headline

Mycoprotein emits roughly **0.7–0.8 kg CO₂e/kg** — about 90% below beef and, notably, *below soy and pea protein too* — while using ~80× less land and a fraction of the water of beef. One leading producer cites 93% less water, 97% less feed and 97% fewer emissions than beef. Peer-reviewed work suggests replacing just 20% of beef with microbial protein could halve deforestation by 2050. For a buyer with hard Scope-3 targets, this is a procurement argument, not a marketing one.

The nutrition picture is more nuanced — and worth being honest about

Mycoprotein’s whole-food profile (high protein *and* fibre, complete amino acids, low saturated fat, minimal processing) is a genuine differentiator in **meat-analogue** applications. But for the pure **protein-supplement** vector, the raw numbers favour isolates: whey, soy and pea concentrates deliver ~80–90 g protein per 100 g versus mycoprotein’s ~45–50 g. The supplement play therefore must be a *differentiated blend* — protein-plus-fibre, gut-health, sustainability positioning — not a head-to-head on grams of protein per dollar, which mycoprotein would lose.

EXHIBIT 7

Whole-food strength, isolate-grade protein density is not the pitch

Attribute	Mycoprotein	Pea isolate	Soy isolate	Whey
Protein (per 100 g, dry)	~45–50 g	~80 g	~85–90 g	~80 g
Dietary fibre	High	Low	Low	None
Complete amino acids	Yes (all 9)	Near (low Met)	Yes	Yes
Saturated fat	Low	Low	Low	Moderate
Format	Whole-food biomass	Isolate	Isolate	Isolate (animal)
Footprint vs peers	Lowest	Low	Low	High

Source: Independent analysis of typical published compositions; values vary by product and preparation.

SECTION 06

The competitive landscape

The field splits cleanly into two camps: **branded product companies** (Quorn, Meati, Nature's Fynd) that own consumer shelves and carry the category's losses, and **B2B ingredient suppliers** (ENOUGH, The Protein Brewery, The Better Meat Co) that sell mycoprotein into other manufacturers' products. The most important competitive fact for an entrant: **the B2B, commodity-scale corner is still sparsely populated** — ENOUGH is effectively alone at scale.

EXHIBIT 8

The mycoprotein field: who's who

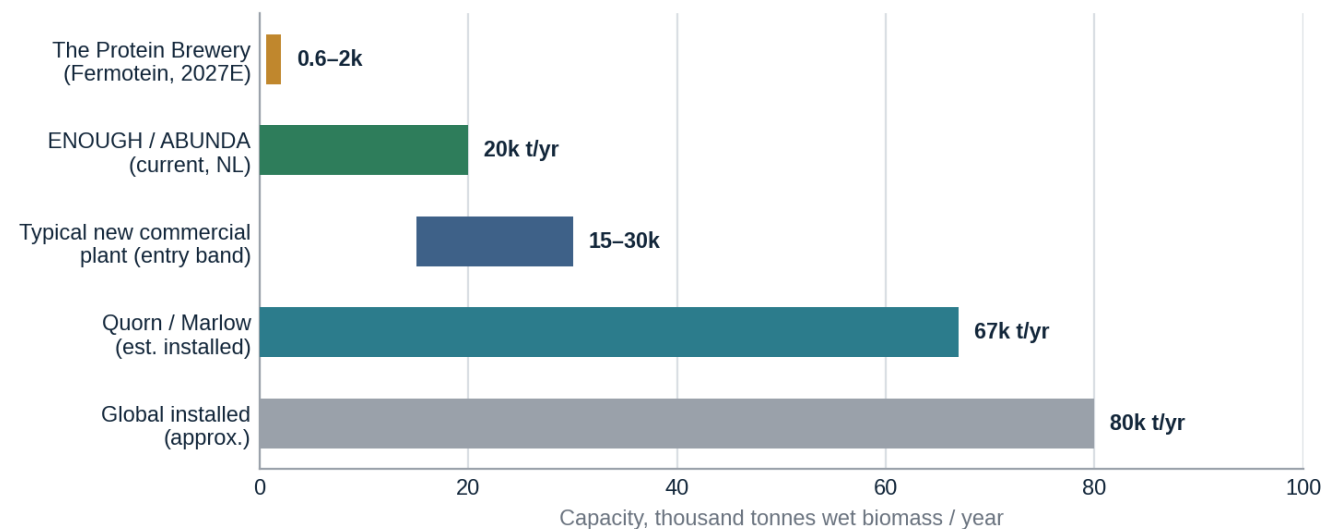
Player	Organism & process	Go-to-market	Capacity (t/yr)	Ownership & funding	Status / notes
Quorn / Marlow (Monde Nissin)	F. venenatum; biomass	Branded CPG + nascent B2B	~67k (est.)	Acq. £550M (2015); heavy losses/impairments	Category creator; ~£187M rev (2024, -9%); "reset" underway
ENOUGH / ABUNDA	F. venenatum; biomass	B2B ingredient	20k (site ≥60k)	~€95M+; Cargill stake + offtake	Co-located with Cargill feedstock; Unilever, M&S, Plukon
Nature's Fynd	F. flavolapis (Fy); surface ferment.	Branded + ingredient	n/d	\$500M+ (Gates, Bezos, Gen. IM)	US GRAS 2021; premium positioning; capital-heavy
Meati (Emergy)	Mushroom mycelium; submerged	Branded whole-cut	"mega" plant (CO)	~\$450M raised → sold ~\$4M (2025)	Cautionary tale: covenant sweep → distress sale → revival
The Protein Brewery	R. pusillus (Fermotein)	B2B ingredient	0.6k → 2k (2027–29)	~€30M Series B	First novel mycelium approved in EU (2026); US+SG cleared
The Better Meat Co	N. crassa (Rhiza); biomass	B2B ingredient	Demo-scale	Private	First non-Fusarium FDA GRAS (2024)
Also watch	Various fungi / gas	Mixed	Early	Sub-scale	Mycorena, Enifer (Pekilo), MyForest, Superbrewed, Solar Foods

Source: Company disclosures, filings and press; independent analysis. "n/d" = not disclosed. Capacities are wet-biomass estimates.

EXHIBIT 9

Sizing intuition: where a first plant should land

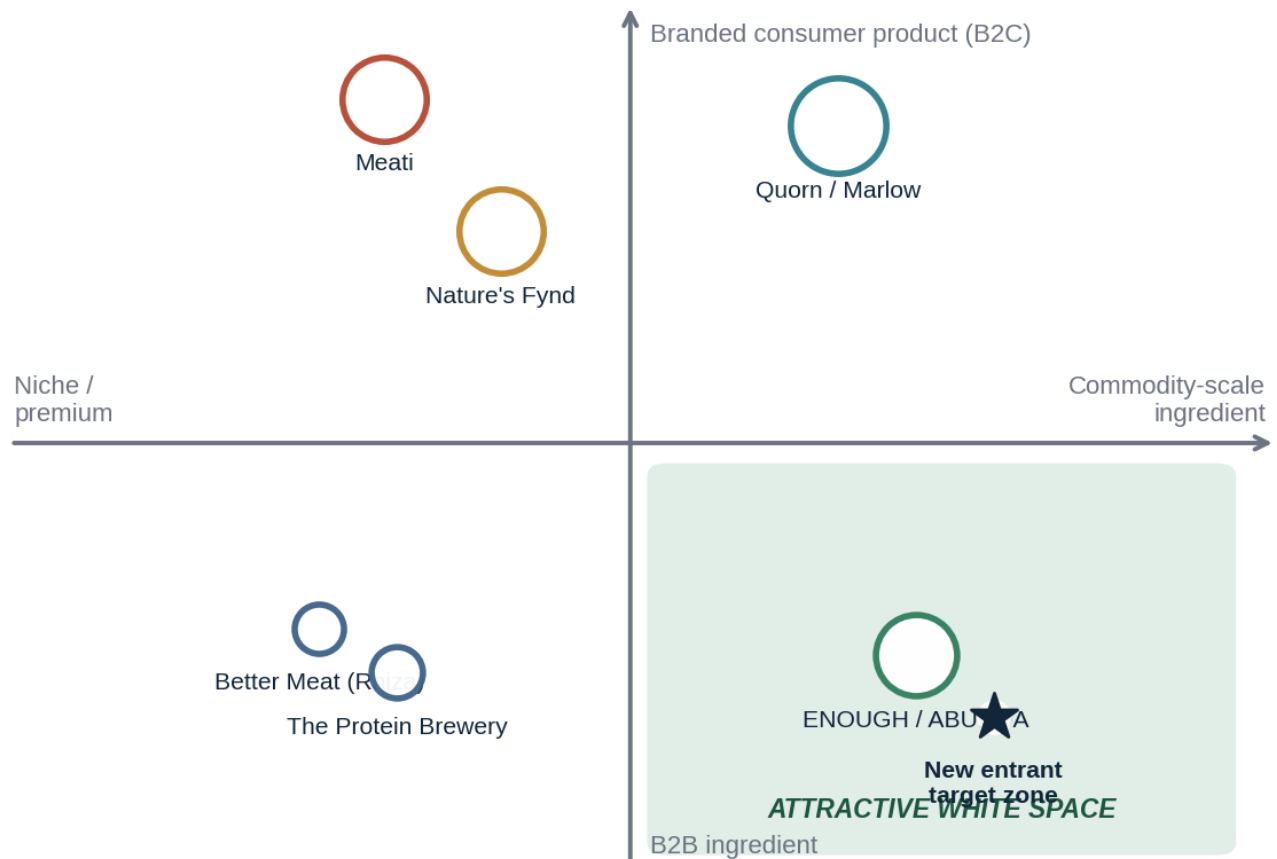
Installed / target capacity benchmarks, thousand tonnes wet biomass per year.



Source: Company disclosures; independent analysis. Global installed figure ~80k is an approximation.

EXHIBIT 10**The attractive white space is B2B at commodity scale**

Strategic map by go-to-market and positioning; bubble size ≈ scale/funding.



Source: Independent analysis.

How to win

Play where ENOUGH plays and Quorn is only now heading — **B2B ingredient supply at commodity scale** — but out-execute on the two things that actually decide this market: **delivered cost** (via feedstock integration) and **application performance** (win the poultry-analogue and blended-meat use cases where mycoprotein's fibre and texture are unmatched). Brand is not the battleground; reliable, low-cost, spec-consistent supply is.

SECTION 07

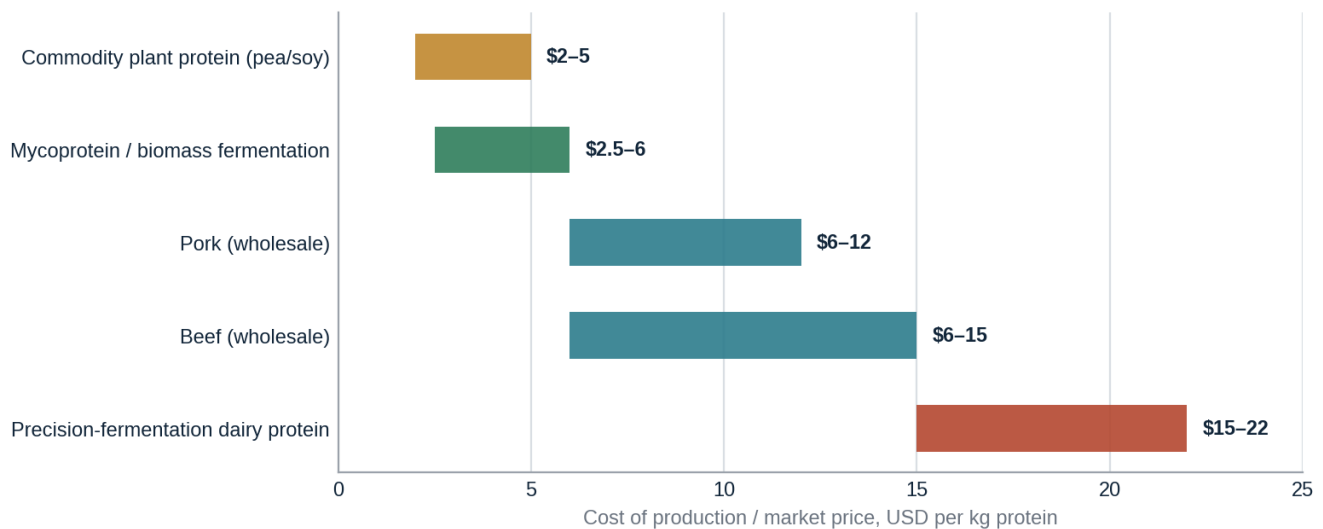
Value chain and unit economics

Here is the good news that the category's consumer struggles obscure: **biomass fermentation has credible unit economics**. Published techno-economic models put cost of production around **\$4–6/kg** (some private models lower), which is below wholesale beef and pork and dramatically below purified precision-fermentation proteins. Competing with the cheapest commodity plant proteins on a pure protein-per-dollar basis remains hard — but that is not where mycoprotein needs to win.

EXHIBIT 11

Biomass beats meat on cost; precision fermentation doesn't

Cost of production / market price, USD per kg protein.



Source: GFI techno-economic insights; published TEA models; commodity price ranges. Ranges reflect model and market variation.

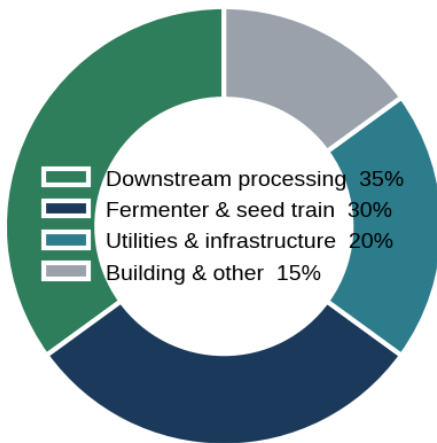
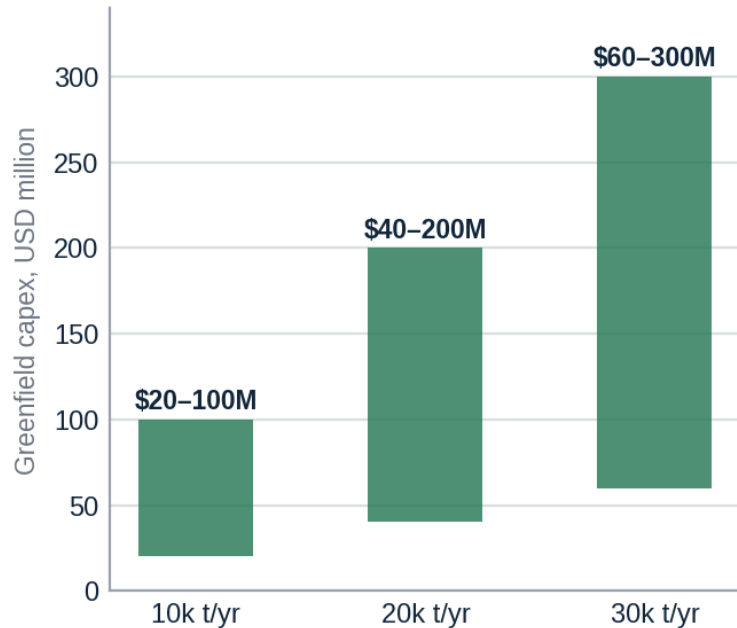
The binding constraint is capital, not cost-per-kilo

The reason mycoprotein has not scaled faster is not that a kilogram is expensive to make — it is that **getting to first commercial kilograms is capital-intensive and operationally hard**. Industry rules of thumb put greenfield capex at **\$2,000–10,000 per annual tonne**; a 20k-tonne plant is therefore a \$40–200M commitment. More than 60% of biomanufacturing ventures that succeed in the lab never reach commercial scale — the “valley of death” that took Meati despite \$450M of funding.

EXHIBIT 12

Capex structure and the plant-size trade-off

Left: typical capex composition. Right: greenfield capex by plant size.

Fermentation plant capex mix**Capex vs plant size (\$2–10k / annual tonne)**

Source: Published bioprocess TEA rules of thumb; independent analysis.

The one lever that matters most: feedstock

Feedstock (fermentable carbohydrate) is ~a third of cash cost, and the models are brutally clear that viability needs a carbon source below ~\$0.40/kg and high conversion yield. This is **exactly** why ENOUGH co-located with a Cargill starch plant — taking cheap sugars in and sending waste streams to an adjacent bioethanol unit in a zero-waste loop. Any entrant with privileged access to low-cost carbohydrate and to industrial utilities starts with a structural margin advantage that a pure-play startup cannot replicate.

SECTION 08

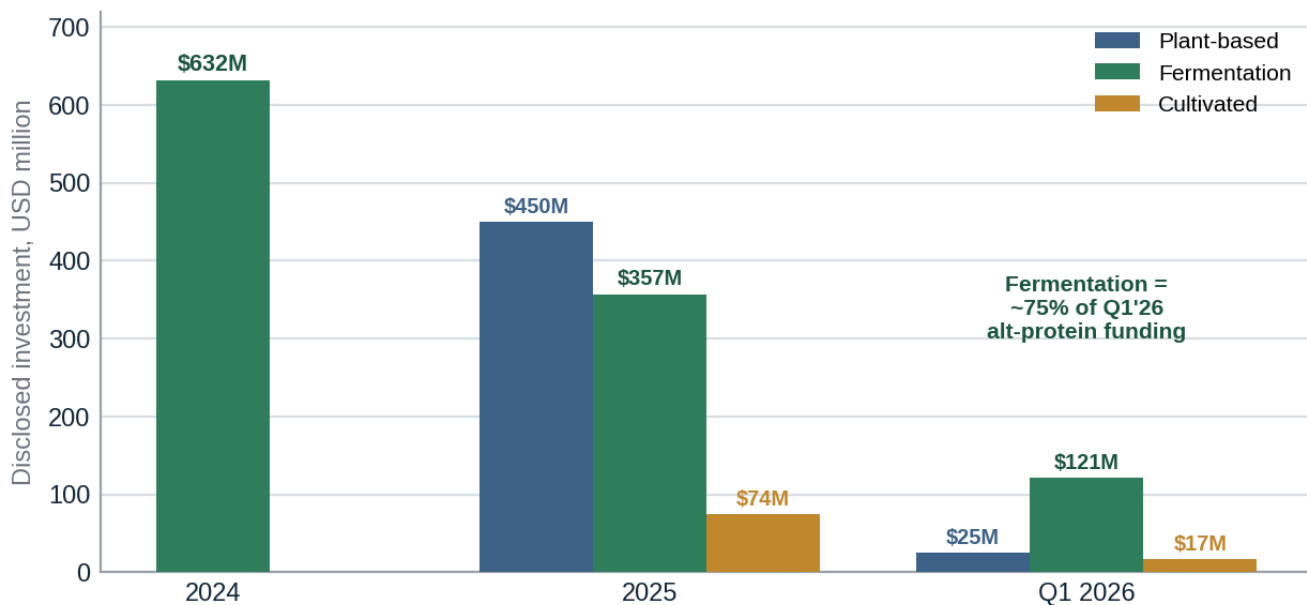
The capital picture

Money is voting for fermentation. Total alternative-protein funding was ~\$881M in 2025 (cumulative >\$19B since 2016). Within that, **fermentation now takes the lion's share of new capital — ~75% of a modest Q1 2026 total** — even as absolute fermentation funding cooled from its 2024 peak. The signal is a flight to the sub-sector with the clearest path to real production.

EXHIBIT 13

Capital is rotating into fermentation — but on tougher terms

Disclosed alternative-protein investment by sub-sector.



Source: GFI analysis of Net Zero Insights data. 2024 shown for fermentation only.

Two things are true at once. The **direction** is favourable: fermentation is where sophisticated capital is concentrating, and four of the five largest 2024 alt-protein rounds were fermentation companies. But the **terms** have hardened. The market has shifted, in the words of one industry body, “from promise to proof.” High-profile failures — Meati (biomass), Motif Foodworks (precision) and Arkeon (gas) — have raised the bar: investors now underwrite scale-up risk, offtake and unit economics, not just science.

Implication for a strategic entrant

A well-capitalised strategic investor is *advantaged* in this environment. The companies that are dying are those dependent on fickle venture rounds and covenant-laden debt to fund capex. An entrant that can (a) self-fund a staged plant, (b) bring feedstock and offtake, and (c) take a 7–10-year view can acquire distressed assets and talent cheaply and build the low-cost position the venture-funded field cannot.

SECTION 09

Regulation as moat and map

Regulatory approval is a real barrier to entry — which means it is also a moat once cleared. The routes differ sharply across the three target geographies, and sequencing them well can save years. The headline: **start where approval is fastest and cheapest, use it to build evidence, then tackle the slow-but-credible markets.**

EXHIBIT 14

A patchwork — sequence entry from easy to hard

Relative favourability of the regulatory pathway by geography.

	Pathway speed	Low cost / burden	Mycoprotein precedent	Market attractiveness
United States	Favorable	Favorable	Favorable	Favorable
Singapore	Favorable	Favorable	Favorable	Moderate
Brazil	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Favorable
Canada	Moderate	Moderate	Favorable	Moderate
European Union	Challenging	Challenging	Favorable	Favorable

Source: Regulatory registers and filings (FDA GRAS; EU Novel Food 2015/2283; Singapore SFA; Health Canada; ANVISA RDC 839/2023); independent analysis.

- **United States — fastest.** The GRAS pathway (including self-affirmation) has cleared Quorn, Nature's Fynd (2021), ENOUGH and Rhiza (2024, first non-Fusarium). Watch one risk: proposals to tighten the self-affirmed GRAS "loophole" could lengthen timelines.
- **Singapore — fast beachhead.** A proactive novel-foods regime (multiple mycoprotein approvals) makes it an efficient first-approval and credibility-building market despite its size.
- **Brazil — newly navigable.** ANVISA's RDC 839/2023 established a defined novel-foods pathway at end-2023 — a material improvement in clarity for a large, protein-hungry market with domestic feedstock advantages.
- **European Union — slow but credible.** The Novel Food Regulation is the world's most stringent (Fermotein took ~6 years to clear). But Quorn is grandfathered (pre-1997 history), and Fermotein has now opened the door — EU approval confers durable, globally-recognised credibility.

SECTION 10

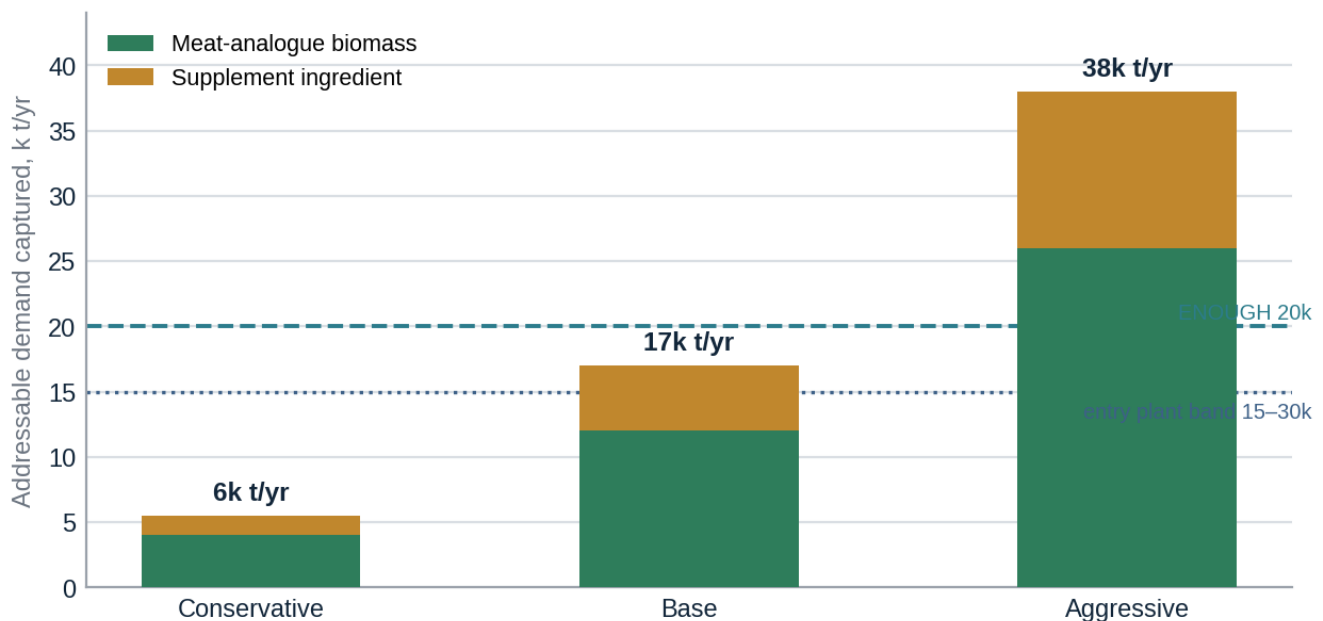
Demand scenarios and entry sizing

Translating market context into a plant is the crux of the decision. We frame demand along the two application vectors and three geographies from the scope, and size a first plant to the **share of addressable demand a disciplined entrant can credibly capture** in each case. The figures below are an *illustrative sizing framework*, anchored to real capacity benchmarks — the precise numbers depend on the entrant's share assumptions and offtake commitments.

EXHIBIT 15

Base case points to a ~15–20k t/yr first plant

Illustrative addressable demand captured by a single entrant, by scenario and vector.



Source: Independent sizing framework; capacity benchmarks from company disclosures. Illustrative — calibrate to internal demand model.

- **Meat-analogue biomass is the higher-conviction near-term vector.** It maps to the largest, most validated end-market (global plant-based meat) and to the applications where mycoprotein wins on merit. It carries most of the base-case volume.
- **The supplement-ingredient vector is a differentiated option, not the anchor.** Because isolates beat mycoprotein on raw protein density, this vector should be sized conservatively and pursued as a protein-plus-fibre/sustainability blend.
- **Sequence geographies to the regulatory map.** Base the first plant to serve US and Brazilian demand (fast/navigable approval, feedstock access), and treat Europe as a Phase-3 expansion once EU approval and scale economics are in hand.
- **Land between ENOUGH and Quorn.** A ~15–20k t/yr first line is large enough to be cost-competitive and a meaningful share of global supply, yet small enough to stage capex and de-risk the scale-up.

SECTION 11

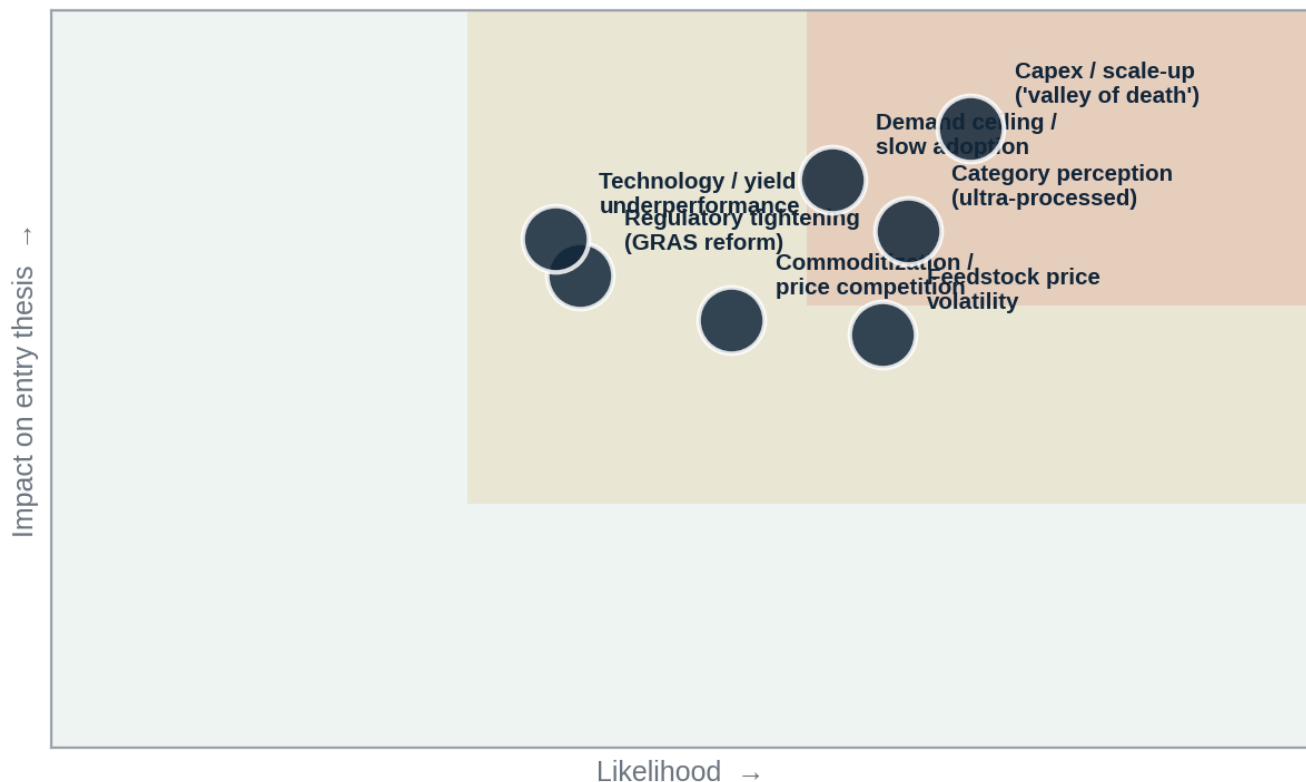
Risks and sensitivities

The thesis is not without teeth. The dominant risks cluster in the upper-right of the map below — **execution/scale-up and demand** — which is where an experienced industrial operator with feedstock and offtake has the most control. The risks an entrant controls *least* (category perception, regulatory reform) are real but second-order to getting the plant built and sold-out.

EXHIBIT 16

Execution and demand dominate the risk map

Key risks by likelihood and impact on the entry thesis.



Source: Independent analysis.

Mitigations

- **Capex / scale-up.** Stage capacity; buy or license a proven process rather than inventing one; partner with an operator who has already scaled a fermentation line.
- **Demand ceiling.** De-risk with binding offtake before construction; anchor to a large customer's reformulation programme; keep the plant flexible across applications.
- **Feedstock volatility.** Secure long-term carbohydrate supply and co-locate; the entrant's structural edge is precisely here.
- **Category perception ("ultra-processed").** Lean on the whole-food, minimal-processing, high-fibre story; target foodservice and blended products less exposed to front-of-pack scrutiny.
- **Regulatory tightening.** File early under current rules; diversify approvals across geographies so no single regime is a chokepoint.

SECTION 12

Strategic options and recommendation

Three routes into the market are available. Given the category's capital intensity, the premium on delivered cost, and the current distress among venture-funded players, the recommended route is **partner/offtake first, then build an anchored plant** — optionally acquiring distressed assets to accelerate — rather than a cold greenfield build or a full acquisition of a struggling brand.

EXHIBIT 17

Build vs partner vs buy — partner-then-build wins

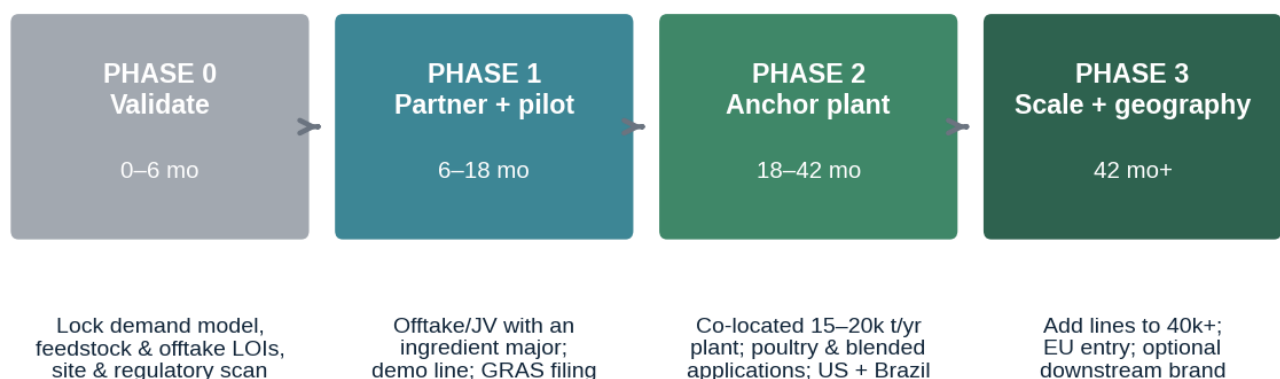
Route	Speed	Capex exposure	Control / IP	Key risk	Fit for entrant
Build (cold greenfield)	Slow	Highest	Full	Scale-up & demand risk borne alone	Weak on its own
Partner / offtake / JV	Fast	Shared / staged	Shared	Partner dependency	RECOMMENDED core
Buy (distressed assets)	Fast	Low (cents on \$)	High	Integration & tech fit	Strong accelerant

Source: Independent analysis.

Where to play / how to win — in one line each

- **Where to play:** B2B mycoprotein ingredient supply at commodity scale — the ENOUGH white space — not branded retail meat substitutes.
- **How to win:** lowest delivered cost (feedstock co-location + staged capex) and best application performance (poultry-analogue and blended meat/dairy first).
- **Where to build:** co-located with carbohydrate feedstock, serving US + Brazil demand first; Europe as a later, credibility-conferring expansion.
- **How big:** a first line of ~15–20k t/yr, expandable toward 40k+, sized to binding offtake.

A phased playbook



Source: Independent analysis.

The recommendation, restated

Proceed — conditionally and as an ingredient business. Commit to Phase 0–1 now: lock the demand model, secure feedstock and offtake letters of intent, choose a co-located site, and begin a US GRAS filing. Gate the Phase-2 capital commitment on binding offtake covering the majority of first-line volume. Do *not* enter as a branded meat-substitute company — that is the one version of this bet the evidence says to avoid.

SECTION A

Methodology, assumptions and sources

Approach

Figures were triangulated across independent categories of evidence and reconciled to reasoned base cases. Market-size ranges reflect the spread of published third-party estimates; where those diverge materially, the report shows the range and a central case rather than a single figure. Capacity, funding and financial figures rely on primary company disclosures and filings where available. Sizing figures in Section 10 are an explicit illustrative framework to be calibrated against the investor's own demand model and offtake commitments.

Key assumptions

- Mycoprotein 2025 market ~\$0.7–0.8B; base-case growth ~10% CAGR (published range 5–17%).
- Biomass cost of production ~\$4–6/kg protein; greenfield capex ~\$2,000–10,000 per annual tonne.
- First-plant sizing band 15–20k t/yr, benchmarked to ENOUGH (20k) and Quorn (~67k est.).
- LCA values are cradle-to-gate and vary by system boundary; beef GHG spans a wide 10–37 kg CO₂e/kg.

Principal sources

The Good Food Institute (State of the Industry and investment analyses, drawing on Net Zero Insights); SPINS and Euromonitor retail/consumption data; company disclosures, annual accounts and press statements (Monde Nissin/Marlow Foods, ENOUGH, Nature's Fynd, Emergy/Meati, The Protein Brewery, The Better Meat Co, Cargill); peer-reviewed life-cycle assessments and systematic reviews; published techno-economic models and bioprocess engineering references; and regulatory registers (US FDA GRAS notices; EU Novel Food Regulation 2015/2283 and EFSA opinions; Singapore Food Agency; Health Canada; Brazil ANVISA RDC 839/2023). Specific figures are directional and current to mid-2026.

Important notice

This document was prepared as an independent strategic analysis for discussion purposes. It is not investment, legal, tax or accounting advice, and it does not constitute an offer or recommendation to buy or sell any security or asset. Market figures are estimates triangulated from third-party sources believed to be reliable but not independently verified; actual results may differ materially. Any investment decision should rely on independent due diligence and professional advice.